

Kibbutz Nahal Oz, then & now.

Pioneering community along the Gaza border

Nahal Oz is only 0.75 miles from the Gaza border. Founded in 1953, with over 400 residents, the kibbutz is a small and close-knit agricultural pioneering community. The 120 families of Nahal Oz, 250 adults and 150 children, run a dairy farm, a chicken breeding farm, and crop-growing fields.

Facing unprecedented loss, trauma, and destruction

On Saturday, October 7th, 2023, instead of waking up to the 70th anniversary celebration, hundreds of families woke up to thousands of Hamas terrorists that crossed the border and infiltrated into Israel. Nahal Oz is one of the communities that over 250 terrorists took over, brutally torturing, murdering, abducting, and massacring families who were hiding in 'safe rooms.' Some were hiding for over 24 hours with no electricity or water, trying to defend themselves and their families.

A brief recap of our loss, in numbers

After hours of intensive fighting, the horrors were revealed - 14 members, ages 8-85, were killed, 5 members were abducted to Gaza, 1 member is still missing, children orphaned, soldiers were killed and injured, other members were wounded, and ***all*** were deeply traumatized. Over 150 homes, land, and cars were damaged, the dairy farm damaged, the medical clinic bombed, and equipment stolen. All - community life, livelihood, and agriculture came to a complete halt.

The community of Kibbutz Nahal Oz, now

The Black Saturday massacre left the kibbutz members, a small and united community, displaced, devastated, and in deep trauma, grieving the loss of their family and friends and praying for the return of their loved ones who were kidnapped. Currently, most of the community temporarily resides in Kibbutz Mishmar Ha'Emek in the north, but we have some who moved to other parts of the country. All income-generating agricultural and dairy farm activities came to a complete halt, causing long-term damage and loss of much-needed income and livelihood to the small community. The kibbutz remains a closed-off military zone, with homes continuing to be bombed and destroyed even now.

The community rebuilding process and aim, one step at a time

With no clear trajectories for its future, the Nahal Oz community is regrouping and beginning what is going to be a long and painful process of healing and community rebuilding. *In the short term*, we aim to maintain the cohesiveness of the community in a time of unthinkable uncertainty. *In the long term*, we aim to create a future vision for the community that will rebuild itself even stronger and better than before, so we return to our homes in Nahal Oz.

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AN OUTLINE OF OUR COMMUNITY'S NEEDS

Following an intensive and ongoing community process, we have outlined the following framework:

1. Emergency fund to victims of terror
2. Community, housing & education
3. Rebuilding Nahal Oz

***Immediate** – Supporting our most vulnerable members.*

1.1. **An emergency fund for families and members most affected by the terror attack** on Saturday, including children who are now orphans and need our support, families whose members were kidnapped and captured in Gaza, and families whose family members were killed. The fund will provide for those most vulnerable who lost their families and loved ones, providing for any immediate needs.
Timeline: Immediate.
Estimated costs provided within the first year - $1,000,000.

1.2. **Tailored psycho-emotional support to members of the community** who face severe trauma, addressing a range of psycho-social needs that require further support beyond what is currently provided by HMOs. Israel's mental health services are lacking staff, responsibility is transferred from one unit to another, and are providing minimal support at this time of great need. To complement the current treatments provided, the fund will enable tailored psycho-social treatments for members of the community.
Timeline: Ongoing, not limited, throughout 2024.
Estimated cost $750,000.

1.3. **Laying the foundation and infrastructure for our community rebuilding** efforts. Following our evacuation and initial trauma and shock, we hired a renowned expert in community building to facilitate the delicate process of remaining united and strong together. To do so and address the wide range of community needs and challenges, we selected two new co Community Coordinators, a Social Services Coordinator and consultants to assist us.
Timeline: Immediate.
Estimated cost $250,000.

***Intermediate** – Accommodating living & housing needs.*

2.1. **A fund dedicated to all temporary housing improvement and supplies** – All possible midterm housing solutions considered will require adjustments and additional renovations and the purchase of appliances to become suitable to the family needs of most of the community. Measures to improve living conditions will likely include renovating and equipping temporary apartments with basic appliances and supplies.
*Timeline***:** December 2023 – March 2024
Estimated costs of renovations and home improvement measures - about $2.5 million.

2.2. Preparing for a year+ of living outside of our beloved kibbutz, we **set up a community fund to provide for a range of basic needs of our 120 displaced families, with**



over 400 members, who now reside temporarily in kibbutz Mishmar HaEmemk, some in Kramim and in other parts of the country. There is a need to provide transportation costs for workplaces that are distant, transportation to reach schools for children that are not on-premises, medical and additional needs that arise from the fact that most of the community is living hours away from the kibbutz.
*Timeline***:** Currently – December 2024
Estimated costs related to the midterm accommodations necessary - $500,000 USD.

2.3. **Establishing a specialized educational system** – The kibbutz has over 150 children, pre-K to 12th grade, who are all affected and facing trauma, and special needs following the Black Saturday and evacuation from their homes. We are now in the process of designing and developing new approaches that account for their needs, as we recognize the traditional education system is not an appropriate solution currently.
Timeline: The planning stage timeline is currently - March 2024, and implementation is long-term upon return to Nahal Oz.
Estimated cost for the planning stage: $100,000.

Long-term *– Rebuilding Nahal Oz, better and stronger.*

In the long term, it is our prerogative to create a better reality and stronger community in the southern region for the community to return to Nahal Oz and resettle our kibbutz. To do so, we will need to rebuild our community – better and stronger than before, to provide a hopeful and improved horizon that will attract families to return.

IT WILL REQUIRE A VISIONARY FUTURE FOR THE REHABILITATION OF NAHAL OZ, SERIOUS PLANNING & CONSTRUCTION OF AN INCREDIBLE NEW COMMUNITY LIFE, FOR FAMILIES TO LIVE AND FLOURISH.

3.1. **DESIGN AND BUILD NEW KINDERGARTENS FOR OUR NAHAL OZ KIDS**. The government funding allows for basic and unwelcoming facilities, and we envision a place where children are safe and cared for, enjoying a beautiful environment at their schools.

3.2. Provide families and individuals who return to the Otef **INCENTIVIZING GRANTS** that will allow for their initial basic needs and encourage them to return, despite the trauma and fear of ongoing security challenges, and consequent economic and social needs.

3.3. **HOME RENOVATION** - Renovate all 150 houses that were damaged to varying degrees in the kibbutz, while there are still bombings and ongoing damage occurring.

3.4. Design and build **A NEW EDUCATIONAL CENTER FOR EXCELLENCE** that will provide the pre-K to 12th-grade children of Nahal Oz with the best opportunities to succeed in the 21st century, focusing on cognitive, interpersonal, self-leadership, and digital skills, alongside emotional support and social skills.

3.5. **INCOME-GENERATING ECONOMIC ENGINES** - Rehabilitate all income-generating activities of the kibbutz, including rebuilding our state-of-the-art dairy farm, recovering our agricultural fields (avocado, banana, wheat), and ensuring economic development opportunities and solutions for our community in the long run.

3.6. **IMPROVED ACCESSIBILITY AND INFRASTRUCTURE** - Build better, stronger, and improved infrastructures, to provide top services and facilities for the well-being, living, and livelihood of the Nahal Oz community. This includes building a new top-notch educational center, a new medical clinic, a super, as well as a new access road**.**



3.7. **SECURITY & SAFETY** - Build and upgrade all safety-related systems, surveillance, communications, and protective measures for the community to regain its sense of security along the border.

Stand with us,
in solidarity & strength. Thank you.